Defeat in Detail: Re-Evaluating Japanese Stay-Behind Operations in Shanxi

Shun Kwok

This was the first open "Banzai to the Japanese Empire" shouted after the war! And one shouted together by Chinese and Japanese forces at that.

Records of the Shanxi Independence War, Jono Hiroshi[1]

Introduction

The Japanese stay-behind operation in Shanxi is one of the most under-studied events in the annals of WW2. Despite the involvement of tens of thousands of Japanese troops and civilians over several years, the incident has been all but ignored by the English language historiography. This article will be the first full English language account of these events, almost eight decades after the events described.

Note on Sources

Currently, the only English-language discussion of Japanese Stay-behind Operations can be found in the article "Staying On: Japanese Soldiers and Civilians in China, 1945-1949".[2] This article provides a summary based almost entirely on the post-imprisonment memoirs of Hiroshi Jono. Since its publication in 1983, a new array of Chinese Primary sources on the topic has become available. This essay seeks to make use of these sources in addition to Jono's translated memoirs[3]. The new materials include post-war prison confessions by Japanese leaders[4], essays by participants on both sides of the Civil War,[5] communist party histories[6], as well as proximate histories of events in Shanxi compiled in the 1950s and 1960s.[7]

Though they cover a diverse range of subjects and perspectives, the available sources are in broad agreement on the main course of events. For Chinese sources, the political pressure of the Maoist Era and the selective bias inherent to archival publication should be taken into account. For Japanese sources, whether prison confessions or post-release memoirs, the effects of imprisonment, interrogation, and re-education on the memory of their authors must be considered. While these biases do not necessarily diminish the factuality of these sources, they constitute an unavoidable censorial and moral filter between the events and question and the modern historian.

Part 1: Background

The Exemplary Warlord

The key enabling factor of the Japanese stay-behind operations was the unique strategic situation faced by Shanxi's provincial warlord Yan Xishan (阎锡山). Yan's acquaintance with the Japanese began early with his education at the Imperial Japanese Army Academy from 1904 to 1909. While never explicitly mentioned, this likely meant Yan was highly proficient in the Japanese language. Following his graduation, he returned to his native Shanxi to serve as an officer in the Qing New Army. An undercover revolutionary, Yan would help launch the revolution of 1911.[8] Through deft politicking, he rose rapidly through the ranks of the new Republican Government. By 1912, he was appointed as Shanxi's provincial governor. The collapse of central authority following Yuan ShiKai's brief Empire enabled Yan to consolidate his power further, becoming one of the strongest warlords during the chaotic 1920s. His rule in Shanxi province only ended in 1928, when a failed attempt to block the rise of Chiang Kai Shek resulted in his fleeing Shanxi for Japanese-controlled Dalien.[9]

The chaos following the Mukden incident of 1931 and the Japanese invasion of Manchuria provided an opening for Yan's return. Flying into Shanxi covertly, Yan swiftly re-established his power base, leaving the weakened Chiang little option but to accept reconciliation. The Japanese invasion of Shanxi in 1937 forced Yan into an alliance with the 8th Route Army in a desperate defence. Despite limited successes, Yan's forces suffered heavily in a series of battles that culminated in the fall of Taiyuan in November. As Yan's old guard disintegrated, communist-aligned organizations spread among his army's ranks. Once the war situation in Shanxi had stabilised under partial Japanese occupation, Yan attempted to counter this threat via a surprise purge against this "New Army" which became known as the "December Incident." Though considerable damage was dealt to the "New Army" Factions within the Army, this action resulted in the defection of its remnants to the Communist Party.[10]

Weakened, Yan reached an accommodation with the Japanese in 1941. The Japanese withdrew from Xiaoyi and supplied Yan with weapons and cash, in exchange for the promise of an eventual break from Chiang. Furthermore, Yan's first and second divisions under Zhao Rui (赵瑞) were transferred to the Japanese under the guise of false surrender, allowing them greater flexibility to fight against the Communists. In 1942, the Japanese attempted to pressure Yan into outright collaboration with threatening movements. They backed off when Yan made clear his readiness to withdraw from Shanxi instead.[11] Despite this partial breakdown in ties, Yan would further dispatch more than a hundred subordinates to serve within the collaborationist administration in late 1943.[12]

These actions put Yan in an exceptional position to absorb Japanese stay-behinds along with Chinese collaborationists at the end of the war. His deep roots in Shanxi allowed him significant autonomy from the central government in Chongqing. Yan had remained in notional opposition to the invaders throughout the war and could not easily be accused of treason. On the other hand, he had developed a good rapport with the Japanese as an effective but autonomous partner, a mutual trust undoubtedly furthered by his military education in Japan. Conversely, the communist presence in Shanxi was powerful and growing. They posed an existential risk to Yan's forces, weakened as they were by war and defection. If the Japanese were to depart entirely, Yan would not be able to secure Shanxi for long against the powerful 8th Route Army.[13] As the guns fell silent, Yan's survival was thus dependent on the army whose surrender he was to receive.

The Undefeated Captives

As the defeat of Imperial Japan became apparent, Japanese officers in China grew concerned about the post-war situation. According to Hiroshi Jono, then ostensibly serving as a representative of the Nanjing Government, he and 1st Army Chief of Staff Michitake Yamaoka first began discussing plans to stay behind with the staff officer Seiichi Kishida in May 1945, when the death of Hitler made clear the inevitability of defeat.[14] The officers began considering the possibility of using the millions of Japanese troops in China as a Vanguard for a renewed Japanese Empire. Moreover, they decided upon Shanxi as the ideal location for launching such an operation.

The Japanese occupation force in Shanxi was the 1st army, which at war's end counted a strength of 60,000 men. While it served as the vanguard of the Japanese invasion force in 1939, the army was of decided mixed quality in 1945, its best armed and trained formations having long been deployed elsewhere. The army could count only one type-b division, the 114th, amongst its ranks; the remaining units were composed of two independent infantry brigades, one independent mixed brigade and an independent security regiment. The 114th Infantry Division, the army's strongest unit, had its infantry formed from battalions instead of the establishment strength of regiments and lacked the usual artillery and engineering elements. Standards of training were low, as were standards of fitness. Four out of every ten of the army's in-theatre replacements were found to be so weak as to require hospitalization upon arrival.[15] Nevertheless, the 1st Army was a proud, undefeated formation at war's end and easily the most powerful force in Shanxi. Its men would form the nucleus of the Stay-behind operation.

Politically, the Japanese had found collaborationist forces in Shanxi province to be relatively amenable and trustworthy. Fighting alongside the first army was the Security Headquarters Command, which commanded "Chinese" forces in the province. By 1945, these had grown to a strength of 50000 men in four security divisions, and increasingly bore the brunt of countering the 8th, Route Army.[16] These collaborationist forces were composed of "surrendered" units from Yan Xishan's armies and led by men loyal to Yan. Given Shanxi was already nominally under the control of the Nanking collaborationist government, it appeared to certain Japanese officers in Shanxi that their "defeat" brought little substantive difference.[17]

The administrative and economic structure of Shanxi also appeared suitable for the creation of a Stay-Behind operation. Administratively, occupied Shanxi was largely governed by former subordinates of Yan's who either retained their positions or were dispatched for governmental roles and Japanese training during the war.[18] Economically, Shanxi province was rich in natural resources and largely self-sufficient. The pre-war industry developed by Yan's North-West Industrial Company had been taken over by the Japanese Shanxi Industrial Corporation led by the infamous Komoto Daisaku.[19] Yan's unwillingness to destroy economic infrastructure during the Japanese invasion had left industry largely intact, and the Japanese hoped to receive favourable treatment by returning the favour.

Part 2: Organization

As early as 1943, the groundwork for the Japanese to stay behind was already being laid by Yan Xishan. This began with preparations to create an 'Asian People's Association'. Ostensibly set up to coordinate anti-communist activities, the organization was in reality an offshoot of Yan's personal 'National Revolutionary Comrades Association', with the goal of retaining the Japanese armies for the civil war to come. Starting from its establishment in May 1945, the organization began pamphleteering in Japanese amongst Japanese troops along the front and in the major cities. The pamphlets employed pan-Asian rhetoric and called on the Japanese to remain in Shanxi. [20] In a discussion just before the surrender with Tan Takahashi, Chief of Staff of the North China Area Army, Yan proposed that Japanese forces across Northern China could be absorbed wholesale by nationalist forces. Though no agreement was reached, these preparations laid the foundation for the Stay-behind Operation.

News of the Japanese surrender reached Shanxi province on the 15th of August 1945, precipitating an immediate rush for control. Within occupied Taiyuan, the Japanese garrison and collaborationist forces continued to hold their positions against the Communists, determined to surrender to the Nationalists. Units of the 8th route army advancing around Lu An and across the province found a hot reception.[21] Meanwhile, Yan's forces were well into their advance through occupied Shanxi, having started their march before the surrender with the connivance of the Japanese. Such was the speed of their advance that fighting broke out on August 12th between the Nationalist forces and Japanese units that were not properly notified.[22] By the day of the surrender, advance units of Yan's Cavalry Army were on the outskirts of Taiyuan. Yan himself travelled more slowly, fearing attack by the communists. Observing a review of a veteran Japanese unit alongside 1st Army Chief of Staff Michitake Yamaoka at Pingyiao, Yan enquired of Yamaoka whether he could have the unit. Caught off guard, Yamaoka could only reply that the Japanese would do their utmost to fulfil his wishes.[23]

Absorbing Japanese forces was evidently a high priority of Yan's. The general met Hiroshi Jono on the second day of his arrival in Taiyuan; and addressed an assembly of Japanese on the fourth, promising of good conditions should they remain. Secret negotiations began in earnest the night after, with Yan represented by Zhao Rui, the general previously despatched to serve with the Japanese. Discussions were held between Zhao and 1st Army officers Seiichi Kishida and Hiroshi Jono for 5 nights until an agreement was reached. This stipulated that the officers and men of the 1st Army would voluntarily organize themselves into new units under Yan's command. They would sign a two-year contract entitling them to three grades' promotions of rank and corresponding accommodation. To administer the transition, the "Second Military Zone Commanding Officer's Collaborative Association" was formed between Kishida, Jono and the Chinese officers.[24]

The association quickly attracted a following of like-minded officers and men, with a core of ideological young officers. Using the printing presses of the 1st Army, it distributed Jono Hiroshi's pamphlet "Stance of the Japanese" across the army as well as to Japanese civilians across the province. "Stance" argued that occupied Japan was facing an existential threat from either Sovietization or Americanisation, but that the imminent Third World War would offer an opportunity to restore the Empire. By conserving and growing its strength in resource-rich Shanxi, the 1st Army would create the base from which this new Japanese Empire would arise.[25] Among Japanese civilians, the influential Komoto Daisaku proved a key lobbyist for remaining. Though dismissed from the army as a result of political feuds, Daisaku retained powerful connections from

his Kwantung Army days and was currently serving as Chairman of the Shanxi Industrial Corporation.[26] With Yan's support, Daisaku continued in much the same role after the war leading the newly renamed North-West Industrial Company. Alongside him were 500 Japanese employees, who Daisaku convinced to remain in their original capacity with guarantees of their continued well-being. Additionally, civilian dependents of First Army troops were also encouraged to remain in an effort to maintain morale.

Planning for the reorganization of the 1st Army continued throughout late 1945, with the initial goal being the retention of an army of 15,000 men in nine infantry regiments. In January of 1946, the reformation began in earnest with a "Special Operations Regiments Establishment Meeting" led by Seichi Kishida. Each unit within the First Army was ordered to form a Special Operations Regiment, with the 114th division forming two. The first Army headquarters was to continue providing leadership and administration, while a military school would be formed from existing Japanese schools for training replacement officers.[27]

Despite the orders to reorganize carrying the name and authority of the 1st Army, most of the Japanese troops and civilians had little interest in remaining. Conflicts between Japanese officers and enlisted became frequent after a political commissariat was formed to pressure men into remaining.[28] Few dared openly voice dissent against the plans to remain, as those who preferred repatriation were labelled as unpatriotic and abused. Most explained their intention to return apologetically, citing family reasons for their inability to remain. In an attempt to enforce the 1st Army's repatriation, the former Imperial Army chief of staff Shūichi Miyazaki visited Shanxi in March 1946. His demands were rejected with the argument that the Japanese were now under Yan's disposal. News of this visit brought tensions within the army to a head, 114th Division chief of staff Otaguro refused outright to participate in the army's re-organization. Jono dispatched a group of officers to change his mind, who accomplished their task either by means of a physical beating (according to interrogations) or clenched grenades (Jono's memoirs).[29] The emotional, ideological and physical coercion applied by the "Remainers" drove some officers to suicide and led to pushback against their bullying tactics. According to Hiroshi Jono, opponents to remaining attempted to have him arrested as a war criminal, which forced him to briefly flee the province. Despite their heavy-handed approach, the "Remainers" convinced only small a minority of the 1st Army's personnel to remain; and over 60,000 Japanese soldiers and 80000 civilians were safely repatriated from Shanxi province after the war.[30]

The initial organization of Japanese troops in seven Special Operations Regiments did not last long, as the cover title of Engineering Units was adopted in March 1946.[31] The Marshall Mission's visit to Taiyuan to enforce repatriation in April 1946 forced the official disbandment of even these. The Japanese troops dispersed from view into the countryside, while leaders were either "arrested" or formed into a 'War Criminals Care Unit', thus gaining official permission from the Americans to remain. Following the mission's withdrawal, the Japanese were swiftly reformed into 6 Security Regiments under the central command of the Shanxi Security Headquarters.[32] They would soon have more serious problems to worry about.

Part 3: Wartime

The first significant combat action involving the stay-behind Japanese troops took place during the Xinxian campaign of July 1946. In his capacity as chief of staff, Imamura Hosaku was unable to prevent the defeat of Yan's 19th army as powerful communist units rapidly captured Guoxian City and advanced on Xinxian City.[33] Besieged within were the Second (Japanese) Security Regiment and the 40th Division, who used the city's medieval walls to resist attacks by the Communist 120th Division. In response, Yan led a relief column of two armies with two Japanese regiments as a personal reserve. This succeeded in breaking the siege of Xinxian City and secured the area North of Taiyuan.[34]

In August, the focus of the war in Shanxi shifted south as Yan launched an offensive in the Shouyang Area, while the Communists attempted to capture the city of Datong. Yan's attack was spearheaded by the Second Echelon, composed of four Japanese and one Chinese Regiment under the command of Seiichi Kishida. Though a surprise attack on Communist positions achieved initial success, the Nationalist units soon found themselves overextended and encircled. In a desperate breakout, the Japanese were forced to charge dug-in machine gun positions with swords; ultimately returning to friendly lines after sustaining heavy casualties.[35] A particularly gruesome incident saw a heavily wounded Japanese colonel order his own beheading to prevent his head from falling into enemy hands. He was obeyed and his head was returned to friendly lines under fire. Fortunately for the Nationalists, the Communist siege of Datong also failed after a month. For his successful command of the defence, Colonel Hiroshi was awarded the City Warfare Medal by Chiang Kai-shek.[36]

A relative lull in combat followed as both sides recuperated. Some among the Japanese ranks blamed their heavy losses on the poor leadership of Seiichi Kishida and demanded his replacement with the more experienced Kaoru Motoizumi. In response, Kishida purged Motoizumi from the Japanese ranks. Motoizumi was forced to form his regiment and serve as second-in-command of the 7th army group instead.[37] In an act reflecting the increasing integration of the Japanese into the Nationalist force structure, Yan officially appointed Michitake Yamaoka as his advisor. Similarly, the Shanxi Security headquarters was absorbed into the Shandong Field Army in the fall of 1946 and its officers dispatched across Yan's armies to provide training. In anticipation of the resumption of large-scale conflict, weapons production was ramped up across Shanxi. Domestically manufactured armoured cars and salvaged Japanese tanks enabled the creation of an armoured unit.[38]

Throughout the occupation, the Japanese in Shanxi formed a variety of political, cultural and religious organizations. Chief among these was the Japanese Expatriate's Club, which served as the central social organization of the Japanese community and contained branches in all Japanese units and companies. This club organized all aspects of Japanese life ranging from sports days and banquets to the running of schools and funerary arrangements. Various smaller organizations also sprang up, from hobby groups dedicated to activities such as poetry, art, songs, drama, and martial arts to Buddhist religious organizations.[39] These clubs had a propagandistic edge and were often used by their organizers to promote Japanese Nationalism as well as arguments for remaining behind. The nationalistic sentiment that these social events engendered was dramatically demonstrated at an incident during a baseball competition organized by the Japanese in Taiyuan.[40] As the Japanese unfurled their national flag, an offended nationalist officer confiscated it; cursing at the ridiculousness of the defeated Japanese flying an imperial flag on Chinese territory. Enraged,

the Japanese Baseball players had to be stopped from beating the officer up. They crowd settled for merely getting the officer arrested by Yan for his “theft” of the flag.

The stay-behind Japanese units would be implicated in war crimes across the breadth and duration of their operations in Shanxi. Setting aside the questionable legality of staying on in the first place, dozens of accusations of specific violations were levelled against the Japanese by Chinese civilians and soldiers. These included the bayonetting and mutilation of prisoners of war, the shooting of civilians, and the indiscriminate shelling of houses.[41] Japanese troops were also frequently identified as accomplices in Yan’s white terror and its trademark practice of clubbing. This practice involved the inhabitants of entire villages being made to club to death those among them accused of Communist activity.[42] During the Battle of Niutuo Fort, the Japanese under Hiroshi Jono were accused of employing chemical shells against communist positions,[43] which inflicted heavy casualties among the unprepared communist troops. This was admitted to by Jono in his prison confessions but omitted in his later memoirs. Overall, if the veracity of individual war crime accusations found in Chinese interrogation records can no longer be ascertained, their sheer frequency speaks volumes about the discipline and behaviour of the remaining Japanese troops.

Part 4: Destruction

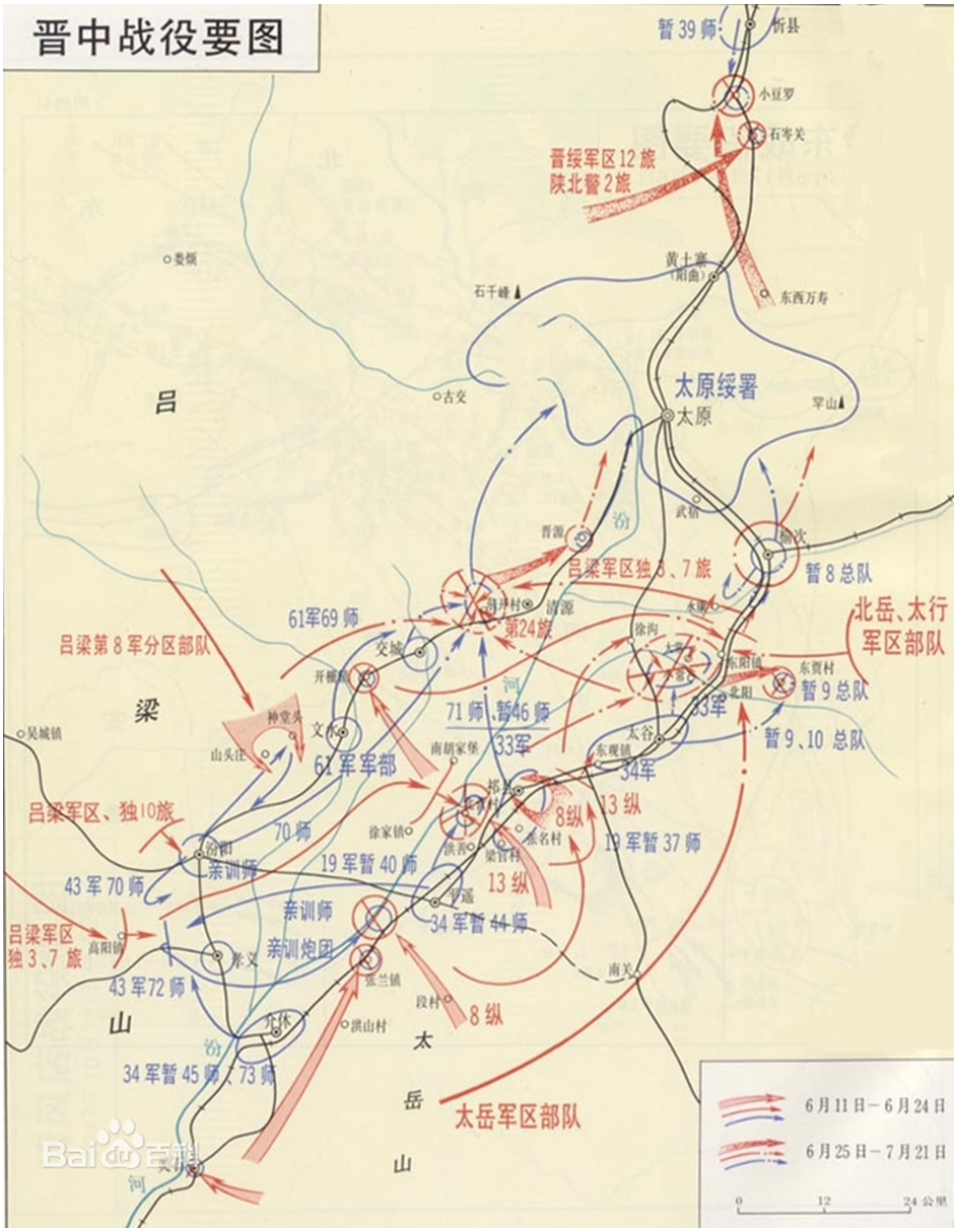
February 1947 saw the resumption of large-scale conflict with the battle of Fenyang-Xiaoyi. The 2nd and 4th communist armies advanced to cut off communication between Taiyuan and Southern Shanxi, rapidly storming the town of Xiaoyi and encircling Fenyang. In response, Yan despatched a relief force composed of two army groups spearheaded by the newly created Japanese armoured unit of 1500 men and 20 vehicles. This force was forced to withdraw after being outmanoeuvred.[44] As a result of this defeat, Yan’s forces completely lost the initiative, increasingly becoming boxed in around the city of Taiyuan.

The battle of Yangquan in May 1947 began with the 10th combined force and the Japanese 5th regiment encircled in the wallless city and subjected to a furious assault.[45] A relief force of two divisions and three Japanese regiments was dispatched east under the command of Zhao Chengshou and Kaoru Motoizumi. Travelling by train, this relief force swiftly arrived in Yangquan. A preliminary plan to advance further east to link up with Nationalist forces sortieing of Beijing was abandoned when those forces were defeated. Soon, the army at Yangquan found itself at risk of being cut off when Communist forces advanced towards the town of Shouyang, located between Yangquan and Taiyuan. A countermarching force was dispatched to secure the lines of communication to Taiyuan, but they found their rail lines disrupted at the town of Qinquan. Leaving the 71st division in Qingquan as a rearguard, the rest of the force completed the march to Shouyang on foot. Now divided in three and vulnerable to defeat in detail, the Nationalist forces had no choice but to withdraw towards Taiyuan. Hopelessly isolated, the Yangquan garrison composed of the 5th Japanese regiment and 10th combined force was forced to surrender; the captured Japanese troops were dispatched to Tianjin alongside their dependents.[46] Following the heavy losses incurred in the battle, the “Japanese” regiments were diluted with Chinese replacements at a ratio of between 1 to 2 and 1 to 3.[47] In a desperate effort to obtain reinforcements, Michitake Yamaoka was dispatched on a recruiting mission to Japan in May 1948 to hire volunteers. He found none forthcoming.

In June 1948, the battle of Jinzhong broke out just south of Taiyuan. With the writing on the wall, the Japanese committed in full force to this final chance to avoid encirclement at Taiyuan. Ferocious battles broke out around the Nationalist forward areas in Qinxian, with Yan’s forces

gradually driven back towards Taigu.[48] A Nationalist failure to secure their flanks due to internal disputes then allowed the Communists to cut off the army's lines of communication with Taiyuan; encircling three Nationalist Armies totalling 60000 men at a stroke. Among this force were five of the "Japanese" regiments. Despite a desperate relief attempt with the support of B-29s, the encircled forces were almost entirely destroyed. The army's commander Zhao Chengshou was taken prisoner, while his second in command Kaoru Motoizumi committed suicide. The few survivors fled for Taiyuan in a disorganized rout.[49]

*Map of the Battle of Jinzhong (*中国大百科全书·军事*)*



Following this catastrophe, the remaining Japanese non-combatants were hurriedly withdrawn from Taiyuan before the airport came within shelling range. Command of the up to 3000 remaining Japanese in the city fell to Imamura Hosaku, who reorganized them into three infantry and one artillery regiment.[50] By October 1948, the siege of Taiyuan began in earnest when the communists stormed Niutuo Fort, a key piece of high ground overlooking the city. For weeks, the Japanese regiments spearheaded a series of counterattacks, contesting the position through furious fighting and allegedly employing poison gas (see above). Despite this, the position was rendered untenable

when the Communists broke through the Nationalist lines to the South.[51] Yan Xishan fled to Nanking in March 1949, abandoning the city to its fate. Hosaku drew up a list of Japanese to be evacuated, but the closure of the airport due to shelling precluded this. Despite this, the remaining Japanese rejected an appeal by a group of Japanese POWs from the battle of Jinzhong now enrolled in the "Japanese People's Liberation Association" to surrender; claiming it would constitute a betrayal of Yan's support.[52] Following a bombardment on the 22nd of April 1949, the final Communist assault on Taiyuan began at dawn on the 24th. The city fell in a morning.[53] The surviving Japanese were taken prisoner or committed suicide, their commander Imamura Hosaku among the latter. Thus, ignominiously concluded the 4-year long stay-behind operation.

Conclusion

Despite its ultimate failure, the Japanese stay-behind operation in Shanxi deserves greater historical attention. The scale and intensity of this operation far surpassed similar stay-behind incidents in Southeast Asia. In the final analysis, the stay-behind operation prolonged the Chinese civil war in Shanxi significantly, allowing Yan Xishan to hold onto power far longer than his own forces alone would have allowed. Beyond its immediate tactical significance, the staying-behind operation provides a unique perspective on the Chinese Civil War. The primary sources contain a wealth of individual stories that this essay has not been able to do justice to. As the first serious English Language analysis of this incident, this essay wishes only to be a brick which attracts jades (抛砖引玉); to be followed by more polished works on the topic to come.

Wartime Military Establishments[54]

National Revolutionary Army Establishment Chart (1942)	Imperial Japanese Army establishment chart (1945)
Military Region (戰區)	General Army (総軍)
Army Corps (兵團)	/
Army Group (集團軍)	/
Route Army (路軍)	Area Army (方面軍1942–1945)
Field army (軍)	Army (軍)
Corps (軍團)	Type-B Division (師団) - 14,184- 17,210 men, 3 infantry regiments.
Division (師) – 8,251 men, 3 infantry battalions	Independent Brigade (独立旅団) Either Independent Mixed Brigade (5,549 men, 5 infantry battalions) (IMB) or Independent Infantry Brigade (3,800 men, 3 infantry battalions)
Brigade (旅)	Independent Security Regiment(独立警備隊) - 5 security battalions
Regiment (團) – 2532 men	Regiment (連隊 - 2,850 men) - 3 infantry battalions with supporting units.
Battalion (營)	Battalion (大隊)
Company (連)	Company (中隊)
Platoon (排)	Platoon (小隊)
Squad (班)	Section (分隊)

Note: Chinese units tend to be more understrength than their Japanese counterparts

Organization of Remaining Japanese units in February 1946[55]

Unit(s)	Location	Antecedent	Strength	Commander
Headquarters	Taiyuan	1st Army	Unspecified	Seiichi Kishida (岸田清一)
Special Advisory Unit	Taiyuan	/	Unspecified	Michitake Yamaoka (山岗道武)
1st Special Operations Regiment	Taiyuan	Various	1,200 men	Shoji Gokan (後閑章次)
2nd Special Operations Regiment	Yangquan	Possibly 5th ISR	800 men	A certain Takahashi (高橋某)
3rd Special Operations Regiment	Yuci	114th Div	600-700 men	A certain Matsudaira (松平某)
4th Special Operations Regiment	Yangquan	5th ISR	Unspecified	Unspecified
5th Special Operations Regiment	Pingyao	114th Div	Unspecified	Unspecified
6th Special Operations Regiment	Taigu	14th IIB[56]	1,000 men	Kaoru Motoizumi (元泉馨)
7th Special Operations Regiment	Yuanping	3rd IMB[57]	1,300 men	Imamura Hosaku (今村方策)
Datong Detachment	Datong	Various	1,000 men	Colonel Hayashi (林豊大佐)
Special Police Detachment	Likely Taiyuan	Japanese in Beijing and Tianjin	Several hundred men	A certain Sumikoku (住穀某)
Total			More than 15,000 men	

Organization of Remaining Japanese units in Mid-Late 1946[58]

Unit(s)	Antecedent	Strength	Commander (s)
Shanxi Security Headquarters	Headquarters	/	Zhao Chengshou (赵承绶) (nominal) Seiichi Kishida (岸田清一)
Security Regiments (no. 1-6)	Special Operations Regiments (no. 1-7) (4th and 5th merged)	1,200 men each	Odagiri Masao (小田切正男), Imamura Hosaku (今村方策), Oba Koichi (大庭孝一), Furuya Atsushi (古穀敦雄), Yobuta Nobuo (薮田信雄), Fukawa Naohei (布川直平)
Datong Combined Detachment	Datong Detachment	500 men	Likely Hayashi (林豊大佐)
Armoured Car Unit[59]	/	1,500 men, 14 tanks and 6 armoured cars	Major General Akahoshi(赤星少将)
Engineer Battalion	Unspecified, likely various	Unspecified	Unspecified
Communications Unit	Unspecified, likely various	Unspecified	Unspecified
Total		15,000 men	

Organization of Remaining Japanese units in Mid 1948[60]

Unit(s)	Antecedent	Table Strength	Commander (s)
10th Combined Force Headquarters	Shanxi Security Headquarters	Reduced due to losses	Imamura Hosaku (今村方策)
Security Regiments (no. 1, 2, 3, 4, and 6)	Security Regiments (no. 1-6) (fifth regiment destroyed)	Battalion sized	Likely as previous
Engineer Unit	Engineer Battalion	Reduced	Unspecified
Communications Unit	Communications Unit	Reduced	Unspecified
Total		Less than 500 Japanese by October 1948	

Bibliography

城野宏著 叶昌纲 金桂昌等译, '日俘 "残留"山西始末--一个日本战俘的自供状,'in 山西文史资料, 第45辑 (1986).

Gillin and Charles Etter, 'Staying on: Japanese soldiers and civilians in China, 1945–1949', *The Journal of Asian Studies,* 42:3 (1983), pp. 498-518.

中央档案馆 中国第二历史档案馆 吉林省社会科学院 合编 日本帝国主义侵华档案料选编 河本大作与日军山西"残留"(北京, 1995).

贾宣宗, '随阎锡山回太原见闻'in 山西文史资料编辑部编□'阎日勾结真相' in 山西文史精选 (太原, 1992).

中共山西省委党史研究室编□山西革命风云录*(一)* □山西, 1986□.

山西政协文史资料研究委员会□ 阎锡山统治山西史实 □太原, 1981□.

阎锡山, 阎锡山日记全编, (太原, 2012).

阎锡山, 阎锡山回忆录, (太原,2012).

贾文波, '上党战役与阎锡山'In 山西文史资料编辑部 编, 山西文史精选 从上党战役到太原解放, (太原,1992).

孙凤翔, '山西沦陷区的日伪统治机器及其相互关系' in 中国人民政治协商会议山西省委员会文史资料研究委员会 编, 山西文史资料, 第56辑 (1988).

平野零儿, '河本大作在山西' in 中国人民政治协商会议山西省委员会文史资料研究委员会 编, 山西文史资料, 第56辑 (1988).

杨诚, '回忆汾孝战役' in 山西文史资料编辑部 编, 山西文史精选 从上党战役到太原解放, (太原,1992).

刘海清, 晋中战役概述 in 山西文史资料编辑部 编, 山西文史精选 从上党战役到太原解放, (太原,1992).

孙凤翔, '为阎效命的日俘就歼记' in 山西文史资料编辑部编□'阎日勾结真相' in 山西文史精选 (太原, 1992).

冉令忠, '激战牛驼寨'in 山西文史资料编辑部 编, 山西文史精选 从上党战役到太原解放, (太原,1992).

刘效曾, '太原阎军被歼始末', in 山西文史资料编辑部 编, 山西文史精选 从上党战役到太原解放, (太原,1992).

Map of the Battle of Jinzhong (军事中国军事百科全书编审室) Image in中国大百科出版社, 中国大百科全书 *(2007),* retrieved https://baike.baidu.com/pic/%E6%99%8B%E4%B8%AD%E6%88%98%E5%BD%B9/10599676/1/e7cd7b899e510fb3fbc3a64fd733c895d0430c14?fromModule=lemma_top-image&ct=single#aid=1&pic=e7cd7b899e510fb3fbc3a64fd733c895d0430c14.

Ness, Leland, *Rikugun: Guide to Japanese Ground Forces 1937-1945: Tactical Organization of Imperial Japanese Army & Navy Ground Forces*, (West Midlands, 2015).

Ness, Leland, *Kangzhan: guide to Chinese ground forces 1937-45*, (West Midlands, 2016).

Orbach and Ziv Bohrer, *"Let the Commander Respond": The Paradox of Obedience in the Imperial Japanese Armed Forces,* in Law and History Review 41, no. 4 (2023), pp. 817-839.

中共山西省委党史研究室等编, 山西革命英烈, 第2辑 (山西,1985).

Seraphim, Franziska, *People's Diplomacy: The Japan-China Friendship Association and Critical War Memory in the 1950s*, in Routledge Handbook of Memory and Reconciliation in East Asia (Routledge, 2015), pp. 196-211.

Benesch, Oleg, *The Samurai Next Door: Chinese Examinations of the Japanese Martial Spirit*, in Extrême-Orient Extrême-Occident 38 (2015), pp. 129-168.

劉熙明, 偽軍-強權競逐下的卒子 (1937-1949), (台北, 2002).

Notes

1. 城野宏著 叶昌纲 金桂昌等译, 日俘"残留"山西始末--一个日本战俘的自供状 p.70
2. Gillen and Etter, *'Staying On,'* pp. 506-508.
3. 城野宏著 叶昌纲 金桂昌等译, 日俘"残留"山西始末--一个日本战俘的自供状, shortened below to 日俘
4. 中央档案馆 中国第二历史档案馆 吉林省社会科学院 合编 河本大作与日军山西 *"残留"'*, pp. 1-2
5. 山西文史资料编辑部编 *'*阎日勾结真相*'*
6. 中共山西省委党史研究室编□山西革命风云录
7. 山西政协文史资料研究委员会□ 阎锡山统治山西史实, pp.440-441
8. 阎锡山, 阎锡山回忆录, pp. 37-84
9. 阎锡山统治山西史实, pp.44-160
10. 阎锡山统治山西史实, pp.211-271
11. 赵承绶, 我参与阎锡山勾结日军的活动情况, pp.1-31
12. 康耀先, 阎锡山派遣部署投降日军的见证, pp.155-162
13. 贾文波, 上党战役与阎锡山, pp. 12-23
14. 日俘, pp. 9-20
15. 日俘, pp.12-13
16. 阎锡山统治山西史实, pp.346-350
17. 孙凤翔, 山西沦陷区的日伪统治机器及其相互关系, pp. 4-14
18. 康耀先, *"*阎锡山派遣部署投降日军的见证*"*, pp. 155-162
19. 平野零儿, *"*河本大作在山西*"*, pp. 115-124
20. 河本大作与日军山西 *"残留"'*, pp. 466-474
21. 日俘, pp.30-40
22. 阎锡山统治山西史实, pp.330-334
23. 日俘*"*残留*"*山西始末, pp.37-42
24. 河本大作与日军山西 *"*残留"', pp. 337-341
25. 日俘,pp.41-47
26. 河本大作与日军山西 *"残留"'*, pp. 200-474
27. 日俘, pp.57-65
28. 河本大作与日军山西 *"残留"'*, pp. 204-205

29. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’,* p. 208, 日俘 *“残留”* 山西始末, pp. 62-65

30. 日俘, pp.60-65

31. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”*, pp. 210-213

32. *Ibid*, pp. 212-214

33. *Ibid,* pp. 210-214, pp. 576-584

34. 日俘,pp.77-78

35. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’*, pp. 214-215, pp. 585-588, 日俘p.78

36. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”*, pp. 214-215, pp. 597-600, 日俘p.78

37. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’*, pp. 216-217

38. *Ibid,* pp. 215-217, 日俘, pp. 77-80

39. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’*, pp. 439-558

40. 日俘,pp.84-86

41. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”*, pp. 572-633

42. Ibid, pp. 633-645, 日俘, pp.126-130

43. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’,* pp. 619-624

44. 杨诚, 回忆汾孝战役, pp. 24-30

45. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’,* pp. 594-597

46. 日俘,pp. 97-100

47. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’,* pp. 217-218, 日俘, pp. 90

48. 刘海清, 晋中战役概述, pp. 84-94

49. 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’*, pp. 227-229, 601-613, 日俘,pp. 136-140

50. 孙凤翔, 为阎效命的日俘就歼记, pp. 172-181

51. 冉令忠, 激战牛驼寨, pp. 212-221, 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’,* pp. 572-633, 日俘pp. 142-147

52. 日俘, pp. 150-155

53. 刘效曾, 太原阎军被歼始末, pp. 262-281, 河本大作与日军山西 “残留”, pp. 231-234

54. Leland, *Rikugun: Guide to Japanese Ground Forces (1937-1945)*, Leland, *Kangzhan: Guide to Chinese Ground Forces (1937-45),* pp. 154–155.

55. 日俘pp.57-65, 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”*, pp. 206-209, pp. 416-438

56. Independent Infantry Brigade

57. Independent Mixed Brigade

58. 日俘pp.75-76, 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”*, pp. 212-215, pp. 416-438

59.

60. 日俘,pp.142-143, 河本大作与日军山西 *“残留”’*, pp. 218-219, pp. 416-438, 为阎效命的日俘就歼记, pp. 172-181